

## USER GUIDE

# Midiplus UP Bitwig Controller Script

Modes, button map, jog-wheel combos, and setup

|               |                                                       |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Script file   | <code>MidiplusUP-MCU.control.js</code>                |
| Hardware mode | Standard MCU mode (manual sections 3.3 / 8)           |
| Bitwig API    | Version 25+ - Bitwig Studio 6.x (confirmed 6.0 / 6.1) |
| Version       | Starcycle + Claude + 3.0.0-native-faders              |
| Repository    | starcycle-controller/bitwig-midiplus-up               |



# Contents

1. Intended Use Case
2. One-Time Setup (MCU mode, overlay, the TRLVL device)
3. Modes at a Glance
4. Modifier Buttons at a Glance
5. Modes in Detail
6. Confirmed Button Map
7. Jog-Wheel "Mode" Buttons
8. Jog Wheel Modifier Combos
9. Where to Find Everything Else

# 1. Intended Use Case

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This script turns a single Midiplus UP unit (in standard MCU mode) into a dedicated Bitwig mixing and gain-staging control surface: 8 motorized channel strips plus a master strip, not a multi-unit MCU array.

It is built around three everyday jobs:

- **Mixing** - motorized-fader control of track Volume and Pan, with fader snap points (to true zero, and to the round dB marks printed on the hardware) so you can land exactly where you mean to.
- **Gain-staging** - a dedicated mode that points the same faders/encoders at a per-track utility device instead of the track's own Volume/Pan, for a separate, non-destructive gain-staging pass ahead of the main mix (see Setup below).
- **Plugin control and navigation** - encoder control of a selected device's 8 macros, jog-wheel scrubbing/zooming/clip and track navigation, scene launching, and automation-mode cycling - all without reaching for the mouse.

On top of that, the script adds a set of quality-of-life extras: whole-project mixer snapshots (store/recall a full Volume+Pan balance across every track, not just the visible 8), auto-banking (the bank follows track selection made elsewhere in Bitwig), and a fader position self-test.

# 2. One-Time Setup

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## Hardware mode

In Bitwig, go to **Settings -> Controllers**, add this script, and confirm the Midiplus UP is switched to standard **MCU mode** (hardware manual sections 3.3 / 8) - not one of the Logic/Cubase/Live "customized" modes.

After loading, check that Bitwig's Controllers panel (or Controller Preferences -> About -> Version) shows the version string on the cover page. An older string means Bitwig is still running a cached copy of a previous version of the script.

## The Ableton Live overlay

This setup deliberately leaves the plastic Ableton Live overlay's **left and right** pieces attached, and removes only its **top** piece. That matters for reading the button map in this guide without confusion:

- Buttons under the **top** piece show their real, printed MCU labels - TRACK/IO, SEND, PAN, PLUG-INS, RETURNS, BANK/CHANNEL, F1-F8, the four modifier buttons, the jog-wheel section, and transport. These are the labels used throughout this guide.
- Buttons under the **left and right** pieces still show old Live-mode stickers (SESS/ARR, CLIP/FX, BROWSER, DETAIL, LOOP, PUNCH OUT, HOME, END, and others) that have nothing to do with what the button actually does in this script. Wherever the button map below shows "(Live label: X)", that is this case - ignore the sticker, the Bitwig behavior listed in that row is what actually happens.

Confirmed on hardware: switching the unit between Live mode and standard MCU mode does not change any button's note number - only local LED/display behavior differs - so this mapping holds regardless of which overlay pieces happen to be attached.

## The TRLVL device (required for Gain-Staging mode)

The **PAN** button's Gain-Staging mode (see Modes below) does not control the track's own Volume/Pan - it controls a separate utility device on that track's chain. For this to work, that device **must exist and must be named exactly TRLVL** (case-sensitive, no extra text).

Bitwig's built-in **Tool** device (browser category **Audio FX**) is the natural fit: its first two native parameters are already Gain and Pan, exactly what this script expects to find on that device's first Remote Controls page.

### To set it up on a track:

1. Add a **Tool** device anywhere in that track's device chain (a common choice is right before the track's own output, after EQ and other corrective processing).
2. Rename it to exactly **TRLVL**.
3. Repeat per track you want to gain-stage this way.

If you press PAN on a track with no **TRLVL** device yet, the script opens the browser at the end of that track's chain automatically, so you can add one in a couple of clicks.

## 3. Modes at a Glance

| Mode                      | How to enter                                                                                    | What the faders / encoders control                                                     |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mixer</b><br>(default) | TRACK/IO button, or leaving any other mode                                                      | Faders: track Volume. Encoders: track Pan. FLIP swaps faders/encoders between the two. |
| <b>Sends</b>              | SEND button (cycles Sends 1-8 → 9-16 → back to Mixer, or 1-8 ↔ Mixer if Send/Return Bank Size = | Faders/encoders: the selected track's send levels.                                     |

|                                   |                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                   | 8); SHIFT+SEND jumps straight to Sends 9-16                                                        |                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Device / Plugin</b>            | PLUG-INS button, or F1-F8 (default orange state, selects device 1-8 directly and opens its window) | Encoders: always the 8 device Remote Control macros. Faders: Volume by default, the same macros once FLIP is on.                              |
| <b>Gain-Staging (Tool Volume)</b> | PAN button, toggle - a sub-mode of Mixer                                                           | Faders/encoders: the Gain/Pan of that track's <b>TRLVL</b> device instead of its own Volume/Pan - requires the Setup step above.              |
| <b>Returns</b>                    | RETURNS button                                                                                     | Same as Mixer/Sends, but the 8 channel strips are the Return tracks instead of Main tracks.                                                   |
| <b>Scene</b>                      | B.T.A. button                                                                                      | Shows the clip launcher and switches Bitwig to the Mix panel layout; the jog wheel selects/launches scenes instead of scrubbing the timeline. |

Every mode-changing button fully resyncs the mode LEDs, LCD text, channel-strip LEDs, and fader/encoder bindings together in one step, and automatically closes a Device-mode plugin window when leaving that mode - jumping directly between any two modes always lands in one consistent state.

## 4. Modifier Buttons at a Glance

**SHIFT** **OPTION** **CTRL** **ALT** - the four buttons directly under the F-keys - are held modifiers for most of what this controller does. Encoder turns, jog-wheel turns, and some button taps all change behavior depending on which is held. A quick tap-and-release of any of them (without using it to modify anything else) also has its own configurable standalone action, described in the full settings reference (see Section 9).

| Modifier      | Broad role                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>SHIFT</b>  | Stepped/coarser adjustment on encoders; jump-to-start/end on bank scrolling; "store" actions (Mixer Snapshots, F-key green state) and the automation-write-enable toggle on DRAW. |
| <b>OPTION</b> | Loop-length halve/double on the wheel; "recall" actions (Mixer Snapshots) and hover-lock for last-clicked-parameter adjustment.                                                   |
| <b>CTRL</b>   | The most-used combo modifier: steps devices, steps clip/track selection, and combines with SHIFT/ALT for clip/track duplicate-or-delete gestures.                                 |
| <b>ALT</b>    | Fine-resolution adjustment on encoders/faders; adjusts the last-clicked Bitwig GUI parameter via the wheel; combines with F8 for the Fader Position Test.                         |

## 5. Modes in Detail

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- **Mixer** (default) - faders/encoders control track volume/pan, or a **TRLVL** device's Gain/Pan if Gain-Staging mode is active (PAN button).
- **Sends** - faders/encoders control the focused track's sends. SEND cycles 1-8 → 9-16 → back to Mixer by default, or 1-8 → Mixer directly if **Send/Return Bank Size** is set to 8. SHIFT+SEND always jumps straight to sends 9-16.
- **Device** - encoders *always* control the selected device's 8 Remote Control macros, regardless of FLIP. Faders control track volume by default and swap to the macros when FLIP is on (press again to revert) - FLIP only affects the faders here, not the encoders. Entered via PLUG-INS, or via F1-F8 in their default/orange state, which also jump directly to device 1-8 on the chain and open its plugin window. Pressing the same F-key again for the already-selected device toggles its window closed/open instead of reselecting it.
- **Scene** - entered via B.T.A.: shows the clip launcher, switches Bitwig to the Mix panel layout, and the jog wheel selects/launches scenes instead of scrubbing.

FLIP swaps faders and encoders between volume and pan in Mixer mode, and faders only between volume and macros in Device mode.

## 6. Confirmed Button Map

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Live-tested against real hardware in MCU mode. Switching the hardware between Live mode (with the overlay) and standard MCU mode does not change any button's note number - only local-firmware LED behavior differs between modes, so this map holds in either.

| Notes | Function                                                            | Bitwig behavior                                                                                                            |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0-7   | Rec Arm 1-8 (SEL row while the standalone REC button is toggled on) | Toggle record-arm                                                                                                          |
| 8-15  | Solo 1-8                                                            | Toggle solo                                                                                                                |
| 16-23 | Mute 1-8                                                            | Toggle mute                                                                                                                |
| 24-31 | Select 1-8 (double-press folds/unfolds a group track)               | Select in mixer / toggle group expand                                                                                      |
| 32-39 | Encoder push-click                                                  | Center pan (Mixer) / reset send (Sends) / Device: hold+turn = fine resolution, or reset macro, or open/close plugin window |
| 40    | TRACK/IO                                                            | Toggle Track Inspector, or switch to Mixer mode                                                                            |
| 41    | SEND                                                                | Sends mode toggle (SHIFT = jump to Sends 9-16)                                                                             |
| 42    | PAN                                                                 | Toggle TRLVL tool-device Gain/Pan control (Gain-Staging mode)                                                              |
| 43    | FLIP                                                                | Swap faders/encoders between volume and pan (Mixer) or volume and macros (Device)                                          |
| 44    | PLUG-INS (SHIFT = EQ Mode)                                          | Toggle Device mode. SHIFT+PLUG-INS jumps to the last EQ in the chain; pressed again, exits to Mixer                        |
| 45    | RETURNS                                                             | Swap channel strips to/from the Return Tracks bank                                                                         |
| 46    | BANK PREV                                                           | Page track bank back (SHIFT = jump to first)                                                                               |
| 47    | BANK NEXT                                                           | Page track bank forward (SHIFT = jump to last)                                                                             |
| 48    | CHANNEL PREV                                                        | Nudge one channel back (CTRL = prev device / tempo down)                                                                   |
| 49    | CHANNEL NEXT                                                        | Nudge one channel forward (CTRL = next device / tempo up)                                                                  |
| 50    | UNDO                                                                | Undo                                                                                                                       |
| 51    | REDO                                                                | Redo                                                                                                                       |
| 52    | NAME/VALUE                                                          | Unbound (no Bitwig equivalent)                                                                                             |



|            |                                                    |                                                                                                                                   |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 53         | SMPTE/BEATS                                        | Hardware-only: toggles F1-F8 backlight/range; not bound in Bitwig                                                                 |
| 54-61      | F1-F8 (default/orange state)                       | Select device 1-8 directly and open its window; pressing the already-selected key again toggles the window                        |
| 62-69      | F1-F8 (green state, via SMPTE/BEATS)               | Configurable editing function per key (defaults: F1=Duplicate, F2=Consolidate, F3-F8=None)                                        |
| 70-73      | SHIFT / OPTION / CTRL / ALT                        | Modifier hold state; standalone tap is configurable                                                                               |
| 74         | (Live label: SESS/ARR)                             | Toggle clip launcher / arranger view                                                                                              |
| 75         | (Live label: CLIP/FX)                              | Toggle device / clip view                                                                                                         |
| 76         | DRAW                                               | Plain: cycle automation write mode (Latch/Touch/Write). SHIFT: toggle Automation Write on/off. OPTION: show/hide automation lanes |
| 77         | (Live label: BROWSER)                              | Toggle browser panel                                                                                                              |
| 78         | (Live label: DETAIL)                               | Toggle note/automation editor panel                                                                                               |
| 79         | B.T.A.                                             | Toggle Scene mode                                                                                                                 |
| 80, 81, 87 | Unconfirmed                                        | Unbound - needs testing                                                                                                           |
| 82         | PAGE (left arrow)                                  | Device mode: page macro bank back. Mixer mode: jump to previous cue marker and follow it with the loop                            |
| 83         | PAGE (right arrow)                                 | Device mode: page macro bank forward. Mixer mode: jump to next cue marker and follow it with the loop                             |
| 84 / 85    | -                                                  | Jump to previous / next cue marker                                                                                                |
| 86         | (Live label: LOOP)                                 | Toggle arranger loop                                                                                                              |
| 88         | (Live label: PUNCH OUT)                            | Toggle punch-out (CTRL = set loop end from playhead)                                                                              |
| 89         | (Live label: HOME); SHIFT = add "Bar N" cue marker | Jump playhead to project start; SHIFT+HOME adds an auto-named cue marker                                                          |
| 90         | (Live label: END)                                  | Jump playhead to loop start                                                                                                       |
| 91-95      | Transport: REWIND / FF / STOP / PLAY / RECORD      | Standard transport                                                                                                                |
| 96 / 97    | Cursor UP / DOWN                                   | Arrow key, or zoom track height (while ZOOM toggled)                                                                              |
| 98 / 99    | Cursor LEFT / RIGHT                                | Arrow key, device select prev/next in Device mode, or zoom timeline (while ZOOM toggled)                                          |
| 100        | ZOOM                                               | Toggle zoom mode for cursor arrows                                                                                                |
| 101        | Jog wheel push                                     | Momentary "Pan Mode" hold; ALT+press = select item at playhead; SHIFT+CTRL+press = same, one-shot; launches selected scene in     |

|                          |                      |                                                                                           |
|--------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                          |                      | Scene mode                                                                                |
| 104-111                  | Fader touch 1-8      | Optionally selects that channel's track                                                   |
| 112                      | Fader touch (Master) | Optionally selects the master track                                                       |
| CC 16-23                 | Rotary encoders 1-8  | Mode-dependent (pan/send/macro); SHIFT = stepped or fine adjust                           |
| CC 60                    | Jog wheel            | Arranger scrub, or bar/loop/tempo nudge with modifiers, or scene navigation in Scene mode |
| Pitch bend<br>ch 0-7 / 8 | Faders 1-8 / Master  | Motorized fader input/output                                                              |

## 7. Jog-Wheel "Mode" Buttons

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This hardware has its own local mode buttons for the jog wheel (CURSOR / SCROLL / ZOOM / MASTER / MARKER / NUDGE / BANK / CHANNEL, per the manual's "Multi-Purpose Jog Wheel Section"). Most send no MIDI at all - they are purely local firmware state that changes what the wheel itself sends when subsequently turned.

| Mode                  | Mode button itself | Wheel click | Wheel turn                                    |
|-----------------------|--------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| SCROLL (base/default) | No MIDI at all     | Note 101    | CC 60 (normal scrub)                          |
| ZOOM                  | Note 100 (toggle)  | Nothing     | Note-On 96/97 (up/down) or 98/99 (left/right) |
| MARKER                | No MIDI at all     | Nothing     | Note-On 84/85 - previous/next cue marker      |
| BANK                  | Note 46/47         | Nothing     | Note-On 46/47                                 |
| CHANNEL               | Note 48/49         | Nothing     | Note-On 48/49                                 |

(CURSOR, MASTER, and NUDGE modes not yet tested.)

## 8. Jog Wheel Modifier Combos

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In priority order (each returns before the next is checked, so only one applies per turn): Scene mode active (move the scene cursor) > **SHIFT** + **CTRL** (configurable) > **ALT** + **CTRL** (configurable) > **CTRL** alone (Device mode: step devices; otherwise: select next/previous arranger clip/item) > **SHIFT** + **ALT** (nudge the selected arranger item) > **ALT** alone (adjust the last-clicked GUI parameter) > PLUG-INS held (step devices) > BANK held (page remote-control pages) > **OPTION** alone (halve/double loop length) > **SHIFT** alone (shift loop by a bar) > default (scrub by whole bars).

### SHIFT+CTRL and ALT+CTRL + Jog Wheel (turn)

Each independently runs whichever action its own Controller Preferences dropdown is set to - freely invertible, both offer the same 5 options:

- **Scale Clip Size** - right doubles the selected clip's content, left halves it.
- **Duplicate/Delete Clip** - right duplicates the selection, left deletes it.
- **Duplicate Clip** (SHIFT+CTRL's default) - right duplicates; left is always a no-op.
- **Duplicate/Delete Track** (ALT+CTRL's default) - right duplicates the current track, left deletes it.
- **Duplicate Track** - right duplicates the current track; left is always a no-op.

Turning left in either "Duplicate/Delete" option is gated by a separate "Allow Delete (Turn Left)" setting (default on) - off, only duplicate (right) is live. The plain Duplicate options never need that toggle, since turning left there is always a no-op by design.

### CTRL + Jog Wheel (turn, outside Device mode)

Selects the next/previous arranger clip/item. With a clip selected, steps between clips on that track; with nothing selected, steps track-to-track instead. In Device mode, CTRL + Jog Wheel instead steps through devices on the current chain.

### OPTION + Jog Wheel

Halves (turn left) or doubles (turn right) the arranger loop length, capped at 256 bars doubling, floored at 1 whole bar halving.

## ALT + Jog Wheel

Adjusts whatever parameter was last clicked in Bitwig's own GUI - click any knob/slider/fader once in Bitwig, then hold ALT and turn the wheel to dial it in without touching the mouse again.

**ALT + Jog Wheel Press** selects whatever's at the current GUI focus - the wheel press acts as the click.

**SHIFT+ALT + Jog Wheel** nudges whatever's currently selected in the arranger left/right by one grid step per message. Full gesture: hold SHIFT+ALT, press the wheel to select whatever's at the cursor, then keep holding and turn the wheel to "drag" it.

**OPTION + Jog Wheel Press** toggles a hover-lock: locks the ALT+wheel parameter-adjust combo onto whatever parameter the mouse is currently hovering over, without needing an exact click first.

## Default (no modifier) Jog Wheel

Always moves in whole bars, anchored on a bar start, at a configurable number of bars per accumulated wheel-tick threshold. An optional adaptive mode can instead scale the jump with the current Arranger zoom level, so a tick always covers roughly the same visual distance regardless of zoom.

# 9. Where to Find Everything Else

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This guide covers usage: modes, the button map, and the jog-wheel combos. The project's [README.md](#) (in the repository root) covers the rest, including:

- Every configurable Controller Preferences setting, grouped by category (Plugin Mode, Function Keys, Zoom, Encoders, Mixer, Debug), with every default value and range.
- Mixer Snapshots (whole-project store/recall) in full detail.
- Development notes and hardware-debugging findings, for anyone extending this script.

[BITWIG-API-FEATURE-REQUESTS.md](#) (also in the repository root) lists the real Bitwig Controller API gaps this project had to work around, for anyone interested in the engineering background.